

Absolutely Brilliant \$750M Ecommerce Subscription Brand

Channel: Arie Scherson · Published: Aug 29, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YEruxs1-09I> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Arie Scherson breaks down David Protein — a \$750M+ subscription ecommerce brand — covering their branding strategy, landing page structure, Meta ad creative mix, traffic sources, and a bonus trend prediction around protein cottage cheese.

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Brand Overview: What Is David Protein? 0:00

- David Protein is a functional snack/protein bar brand with both ecommerce and retail presence
 - Arie focuses specifically on the ecommerce side
- Valued at **over \$750 million** in roughly one year or less of operation
 - The founder previously founded RXBAR, a well-known protein bar brand, giving him significant category expertise
- Their stated ambition appears to be owning the entire functional snacks category, not just protein bars
- Currently driving approximately **500,000 monthly visitors** to their site, primarily from the US
 - Some traffic also comes from Canada, Germany, and the UK — suggesting early seeds of global expansion
- Running **490 active ads** in the US at time of review

Branding & Aesthetic Strategy 1:13

- The brand deliberately does NOT look like a protein bar company

- Arie compares the visual identity to a fashion designer's studio
- Reminds him of a designer brand called Alix — an "if you know, you know" niche label
- This is described as "the perfect blend of science and art"
- Key takeaway for new brand builders: **you don't need to reinvent the structural wheel**
 - Use the same proven page structure that successful brands use
 - Differentiate through font, branding, and identity — not layout
- Arie notes they are not responding to many social media comments
 - His theory: trying to maintain brand mystique/authenticity
 - His suggestion: use a tool like Smart Reply to handle comment responses as customer touchpoints

Landing Page & Subscription Model 1:57

- Their main page functions more as a **sales/landing page** than a standard Shopify product page
 - Headline reads: *"The most effective portable protein"*
 - Structured to sell, not just display
- Subscribe and save is the **default purchase option** on the site
 - Saves customers **10% off every order** (not just the first)
 - Delivery cadence options: 2 weeks, 4 weeks, or 8 weeks
 - One-time purchase is also available as an alternative
- Arie personally runs a subscription ecommerce brand and calls it "the best kind of business" in the current AI wave
 - His own brand is already at **over \$250K in monthly recurring revenue** within its first year
- Page structure follows the same template seen across 2,000+ successful ecom stores Arie has reviewed
 - Described as "really simple" and "really clean" beyond the hero section

Proprietary Ingredient & Product Edge 3:53

- David Protein owns a proprietary ingredient called **Epigé** (or similar — Arie says "I believe")
 - It functions as a **fat substitute**
 - Enables very low-calorie products that are still high in protein and macronutrients
- This is what allows their flagship bars to hit unusually favorable macros (high protein, low calorie)
- Arie frames this as an "endgame" brand-level moat — comparing it to SpaceX-level ambition applied to protein bars
- One bestselling product highlighted: the **Blueberry Pie protein bar**
- They recently launched **protein ice cream** as a new product line

Traffic Sources & Meta Ads Strategy 5:06

- Primary paid traffic source: **Meta Ads**
 - Arie emphasizes Meta is "extremely powerful and only getting more powerful"
 - He runs a Meta Ads agency called **The Chemi**, described as holding the highest Meta agency partner status available
- ~500,000 monthly visitors, majority US-based
- Key point for smaller brands:
 - You don't need to spend \$100,000/month to start
 - **\$50/day** is enough to test ads effectively if the landing page and offer are solid
- Free resource used in the video: **Meta Ads Library**, sorted by highest impressions
 - Arie also mentions **Get Hooked** as a superior paid spy tool for Meta ads

Ad Creative Breakdown 6:16

- Top-performing ads (by impressions) are **almost entirely image ads**
 - Image ads are easy to produce and, importantly, easy to replicate and test
- Ad mix breaks down into two categories:
 - **Unique mechanism/product ads** — highlight the bar's low-calorie, high-protein profile; scroll-stopping because the product looks unlike any other protein bar
 - Example copy: *"David delivers the most protein for the fewest calories. Perfected taste, texture, and macros. Have it all with David."*
 - Arie praises this as concise copywriting that covers value proposition and unique mechanism in one pass
 - **Offer-heavy ads** — heavily use the word "free"
 - Examples: "Buy 4 get 1 free," "Your first order ships free"
 - Not reinventing the wheel — just executing proven offers with clean David branding
- They also run **UGC (user-generated content)** creator ads
 - Arie sees UGC as increasingly valuable but advises against prioritizing it at launch due to cost
 - Mentions **Tribe** as a platform that lets brands work with creators on a performance basis (pay based on results), reducing upfront cost
- They run **partnership/collaboration ads** via Meta
 - Example: a partnership ad run with **Train by Tay**
 - This is a native Meta Ads feature that allows co-branded ad promotion

Bonus Trend Prediction: Protein Cottage Cheese 10:01

- Protein cottage cheese is experiencing a major spike in search volume and consumer demand right now
- Arie's prediction: **David Protein will launch a cottage cheese product** as it fits their high-protein, low-calorie positioning perfectly

- Opportunity for entrepreneurs to front-run this trend before David enters:
 - Use ChatGPT or Claude to generate a list of cottage cheese manufacturers and suppliers
 - Draw inspiration from David's branding and ad approach for positioning
 - Negotiate with a supplier who may be willing to both manufacture and potentially fulfill (dropship) directly to customers
 - Build a **subscription protein cottage cheese brand** around this model
- Arie frames this as a scrappy, actionable opportunity available right now